Law Enforcement 52-Week Fitness & Readiness Program

A Year-Long Guide to Pursuit Speed, Use-of-Force Strength, Back Health & Shift Resilience

1. PROGRAM OVERVIEW & KEY RULES

Cardiovascular fitness is the foundation of all tactical performance. A strong heart and aerobic base protect officers against sudden adrenaline spikes on duty and allow rapid recovery during foot pursuits, stair climbs, and physical arrests while wearing 20–50 lbs of duty belt and body armor. Because over 60% of officers experience lower-back pain from cruiser sitting and gear weight, this 52-week plan combines 3–4 weekly running sessions with core stiffness, hip mobility, grip strength, and functional lifting.

- **Cardio Is Your Foundation:** You will run 3–4 times per week (mixing steady aerobic runs, 100m–400m tempo/interval runs, and hill sprints) alongside 3 targeted strength sessions.
- **Squat Depth & Back Protection:** Squat until your thighs are parallel to the floor with a flat, braced back. Never do straight-leg sit-ups, double leg lifts, or standing twisting crunches—use planks, side planks, bird dogs, and loaded carries instead.
- **Recovery Weeks (Deloads):** Every 4th week is a recovery week. Cut your strength sets and running distance by 40% so your body adapts and stays injury-free.
- **Shift-Work Rule:** If you are coming off a sleep-deprived night shift or double shift, cut your accessory sets in half and swap hard intervals for a 20–30 minute easy aerobic run or walk.
- **Nutrition & Hydration:** Pack lean protein (0.75–1.0 g per lb of body weight) and high-fiber carbs for your shift to fuel your runs and avoid convenience-food crashes. Drink water consistently throughout your tour.

2. HOW & WHEN TO PROGRESS SETS, REPS & WEIGHTS

Progress only works if you increase difficulty gradually—never add sets, reps, and weight all in the same week. Follow these four simple rules across every 3-week training block:

Progression Variable	When to Increase	How Much to Add
1. Reps First (Double Progression)	When a lift lists a rep range (e.g., **10–12 reps** or **6–8 reps**), keep the same weight until you can complete the top number of reps on *every* set with clean form and 1–2 reps left in the tank.	Add **1–2 reps per set** each workout until you hit the top of the rep range.
2. Weight Second (Load Progression)	Once you hit the top rep target on all sets (e.g., 4 sets of 12 reps) with solid form and a flat back, increase the weight on your next session and drop back to the bottom of the rep range (e.g., 10 reps).	Add **2.5–5 lbs** (1–2 kg) for upper-body lifts and **5–10 lbs** (2.5–5 kg) for lower-body lifts (never more than 5% at once).
3. Sets Third (Volume Progression)	When a lift lists a set range (e.g., **3–4 sets** or **4–5 sets**), start at the lower number in Week 1 of a block. Only add a set if you recovered well with zero joint pain.	Perform **3 sets in Week 1**, **4 sets in Weeks 2–3**, and drop back to **2 sets on Week 4 (Deload)**.

Progression Variable	When to Increase	How Much to Add
4. Cardio & Vest Work (Distance vs. Load)	Never increase vest weight, running distance, and running speed in the same week.	Increase running distance by **no more than 10% per week**. Master bodyweight runs first before adding a 20–30 lb vest.

MANDATORY 10-MINUTE DIME WARM-UP (DO BEFORE EVERY WORKOUT)

Never do long static stretches before lifting or sprinting—it temporarily reduces strength and power. Instead, complete this 9-move **Dynamic Integrated Movement Enhancement (DIME)** circuit to warm up joints and prevent knee and back injuries:

Exercise	Reps / Time	Exercise	Reps / Time	Exercise	Reps / Time
1. Bodyweight Squats	10 reps	4. Side Plank	20 sec / side	7. Side Hop to Balance	6 hops / side
2. Squat Jumps	8 reps	5. Push-Ups	10 reps	8. Ice Skaters (Lateral)	8 / side
3. Forward Lunges	8 reps / leg	6. Single-Leg Reach	6 reps / leg	9. "L" Hops (Forward/Side)	5 hops / leg

Cool-Down (5–10 Mins): Finish every workout with light walking and 20–30 second static stretches for hip flexors, hamstrings, calves, and chest.

3. WEEKLY TRAINING SCHEDULE (5 DAYS/WEEK)

Day	Workout Focus	Session Goal
Day 1	Lower-Body Strength + Easy Base Run	Build leg and hip strength for takedowns and back protection, plus a 3,000m run.
Day 2	Cardio Endurance & Tempo Running	Build a strong aerobic heart base and faster 2,400m–5,000m run stamina.
Day 3	Upper-Body Strength & Grappling Grip	Build pushing, pulling, and hand/forearm strength for suspect control and climbing.
Day 4	Mid-Week Steady Run & Hip Mobility	4,000–6,000m conversational Zone 2 run + hip flexor/hamstring decompression.
Day 5	Sprint Speed, Agility & Use-of-Force Circuit	Develop quick first-step pursuit speed, sharp cuts, and 60–90s struggle stamina.
Days 6–7	Rest & Shift Recovery	Focus on 7–9 hours of dark, cool sleep and meal prep for upcoming shifts.

4. QUARTER 1 (WEEKS 1–13): AEROBIC BASE, POSTURE & CORE STABILITY

Goal: Build a solid cardiovascular running foundation (4 runs/week), undo tight hips and rounded shoulders from patrol driving, and strengthen core stability. Lower weights slowly (3 seconds down).

Day	Exercise	Sets	Reps / Distance / Time	Effort / Weight	Rest
Day 1 Lower + Run	Goblet Squat or Back Squat (to parallel)	3–4	10–12 reps	Moderate (RPE 7)	90 sec
	Trap-Bar Deadlift or Dumbbell RDL	3–4	10–12 reps	Moderate (RPE 7)	90 sec
	Reverse Lunges	3	10 / leg	Bodyweight / Light DBs	60 sec
	McGill Curl-Up + Side Plank + Bird Dog	3	10 sec holds each	Bodyweight	45 sec
	Post-Lift Aerobic Run	1	3,000m	Easy Conversational Pace	—
Day 2 Cardio Base	Steady Aerobic Run (build distance weekly)	1	4,000–5,000m	Conversational Pace	—
Day 3 Upper Body	Dumbbell Bench Press or Push-Ups	3–4	10–12 reps	Moderate (RPE 7)	90 sec
	Chin-Ups (or Band-Assisted Pull-Ups)	4	6–8 reps	Bodyweight / Band	90 sec
	Seated or Standing Dumbbell Shoulder Press	3	10–12 reps	Moderate (RPE 7)	90 sec
	Single-Arm Dumbbell Row + Band Pull-Aparts	3	10 / arm + 15 reps	Moderate / Light	60 sec
Day 4 Cardio Base	Steady Aerobic Run + 10-Min Hip Mobility	1	4,000m	Easy Conversational Pace	—
Day 5 Full Body + Run	Two-Arm Kettlebell Swings	4	15 reps	Moderate KB	60 sec
	Lateral Lunges (side-to-side hip strength)	3	8 / side	Bodyweight / Light DBs	60 sec
	Half-Kneeling Pallof Press (Anti-Rotation)	3	12 / side	Moderate Band/Cable	60 sec
	One-Arm Suitcase Carry	3	25m / arm	Moderate Dumbbell/KB	60 sec

Day	Exercise	Sets	Reps / Distance / Time	Effort / Weight	Rest
Easy Finisher Run	1	2,400m	Easy Pace	—	

5. QUARTER 2 (WEEKS 14–26): RUNNING STAMINA & GRAPPLING STRENGTH

Goal: Increase running stamina with 100m–400m tempo/interval sessions and 5,000–6,000m runs while building lean muscle and grip strength for ground control.

Day	Exercise	Sets	Reps / Distance / Time	Effort / Weight	Rest
Day 1 Lower + Run	Barbell Back Squat (parallel depth)	4	6–8 reps	Challenging (RPE 8)	2–3 min
	Conventional or Sumo Barbell Deadlift	4	6 reps	Challenging (RPE 8)	2–3 min
	Bulgarian Split Squat (rear foot elevated)	3	8 / leg	Moderate Dumbbells	90 sec
	Tall-Kneeling Pallof Press + Glute Bridge	3	10 / side + 15 reps	Moderate Band/Cable	60 sec
	Post-Lift Aerobic Run	1	3,000m	Easy Recovery Pace	—
Day 2 Tempo & Vest	100m Tempo Runs (smooth, consistent speed)	10	100m (~16–18s)	Moderate (65–75% speed)	45 sec walk
	Brisk Walk or Light Jog Wearing 20–30 lb Vest	1	2,400m	Brisk Pace	—
Day 3 Upper Body	Barbell Bench Press or Incline Press	4	6–8 reps	Challenging (RPE 8)	2–3 min
	Weighted or Strict Pull-Ups	4	6–8 reps	BW or +10–25 lbs	2 min
	Single-Arm Landmine Press (staggered stance)	3	8 / arm	Moderate	90 sec
	Inverted Row + Barbell Deadlift Grip Hold	3	10 reps + 30 sec	BW / 60% Max Deadlift	90 sec
Day 4 Long Run	Long Steady Aerobic Run	1	5,000–6,400m	Steady Zone 2 Pace	—
Day 5 Sandbag/Sled	Sandbag Shouldering (lift to shoulder)	4	6 / side	70–100 lb Sandbag	90 sec
	Sandbag Bear-Hug Walk + Squats	3	30m + 8 squats	70–100 lb Sandbag	90 sec

Day	Exercise	Sets	Reps / Distance / Time	Effort / Weight	Rest
Rotational Medicine Ball Wall Throw	3	8 / side	10–14 lb Med Ball	60 sec	
Heavy Sled Push & Backward Drag	4	15m out / 15m back	Heavy (75–80% effort)	2 min	

6. QUARTER 3 (WEEKS 27–39): LIMIT STRENGTH, PURSUIT SPEED & THRESHOLD RUNS

Goal: Build maximum strength while moving every rep upward as fast as possible, paired with short sprints, agility drills, and sustained 4,000–6,000m tempo runs.

Day	Exercise	Sets	Reps / Distance / Time	Effort / Weight	Rest
Day 1 Lower Max	Box Jumps (step down; land softly)	4	4 reps	Max Jump Height	2 min
	Barbell Back Squat (explode up fast)	4–5	3–5 reps	Heavy (85–92% Max)	3–5 min
	Conventional Barbell Deadlift	3–4	3–4 reps	Heavy (85–90% Max)	3–5 min
	Standing Pallof Hold + Heavy Farmer's Walk	3	20s / side + 25m	Heavy	90 sec
Day 2 Pursuit/Agility	10m & 20m Sprint Starts (from ready stance)	6	10–20m	All-Out (95–100%)	90 sec
	Pro Agility (5m-10m-5m) & 10m T-Test Cone Drills	3	1 rep each drill	All-Out (sharp cuts)	2 min
	Easy Recovery Run	1	3,200m	Easy Pace	—
Day 3 Upper Max	Explosive Push-Ups or Med Ball Chest Pass	4	5 reps	Bodyweight / 10 lb Ball	90 sec
	Barbell Bench Press (explode up fast)	4–5	3–5 reps	Heavy (85–92% Max)	3–5 min
	Weighted Pull-Ups	4	4–6 reps	Heavy	3 min
	Standing Barbell Push Press + Face Pulls	4	4 + 15 reps	Heavy (80–85% Max)	2 min
Day 4 Tempo Run	Sustained Tempo Run (fast, controlled pace)	1	4,800–6,400m	Threshold (75–80% HRR)	—
Day 5 Power & RSA	Trap-Bar Jumps (jump explosively)	4	3 reps	Light (20% Squat Max)	2 min

Day	Exercise	Sets	Reps / Distance / Time	Effort / Weight	Rest
Speed Bench Press (max bar speed)	6	3 reps	Moderate (55–65% Max)	60 sec	
Medicine Ball Overhead Slam + Rotational Lunge	3	8 reps each	10–14 lb Med Ball	60 sec	
40m Sprint Repeats (Repeat Sprint Ability)	8–10	40m	Hard (90–95% effort)	35 sec	

7. QUARTER 4 (WEEKS 40–52): USE-OF-FORCE READINESS & ANNUAL PEAK

Goal: Put strong aerobic endurance, strength, and speed together into realistic police pursuit and arrest circuits. **Week 51:** Cut volume by 50% (Taper). **Week 52:** Final Fitness Test.

Day	Exercise	Sets	Reps / Distance / Time	Effort / Weight	Rest
Day 1 Lower Maintain	Standing Long Jump (Broad Jump)	3	3 reps	Max Distance	2 min
	Barbell Back Squat	3	3–4 reps	Heavy (80–85% Max)	3 min
	Conventional or Trap-Bar Deadlift	3	3 reps	Heavy (80–85% Max)	3 min
	Staggered-Stance Pallof Press	3	10 / side	Moderate-Heavy	60 sec
Day 2 Hill/Cardio	Hill Sprints (easier on hamstrings than flat sprints)	6	30m	All-Out (95%)	90 sec walk
	Steady Aerobic Run	1	4,000–5,000m	Conversational Pace	—
Day 3 Upper Maintain	Barbell Bench Press	3	3–4 reps	Heavy (80–85% Max)	3 min
	Strict Pronated Pull-Ups	3	Max (stop 1 shy)	Bodyweight or +Vest	2 min
	Single-Arm Dumbbell Bench Press	3	8 / arm	Moderate-Heavy	90 sec
	Heavy Farmer's Walk	3	30m	Heavy Dumbbells/Handles	90 sec
Day 4 Aerobic Base	Steady Zone 2 Recovery Run	1	4,800m	Easy Conversational Pace	—

Day	Exercise	Sets	Reps / Distance / Time	Effort / Weight	Rest
Day 5 Duty Circuit	**4 Rounds Wearing 20-lb Weight Vest (60–90s/round):** • 45m Pursuit Sprint + 1.2m Barrier Vault / Box Step-Over • 15m Low Crawl + 10 Sledgehammer Tire Strikes • 165-lb Dummy / Heavy Sled Drag (10m out, turn, 10m back) • 30s Heavy Sandbag Bear-Hug Hold / Ground Control Drill	4	1 full circuit	Hard (85–95% effort)	2–3 min between rounds

8. TARGET FITNESS BENCHMARKS (TEST WEEKS 0, 13, 26, 39 & 52)

Fitness Test	Solid Duty Baseline	Strong Standard	Elite Standard
2,400m (1.5-Mile) Run / 5,000m Run	≤ 11:30 / ≤ 25:00	≤ 10:15 / ≤ 22:00	≤ 9:30 / ≤ 20:00
Back Squat & Deadlift (1-Rep Max)	2.0 × Body Weight	2.2 × Body Weight	2.5 × Body Weight
Bench Press (1-Rep Max) / Push-Ups	1.25 × BW / 35 Push-Ups	1.5 × BW / 45 Push-Ups	1.75 × BW / 55+ Push-Ups
Strict Pull-Ups / 40m Sprint	8 reps / ≤ 5.70 sec	12 reps / ≤ 5.30 sec	15+ reps / ≤ 5.00 sec
Vertical Jump / Body Fat %	50 cm / < 17% (M), < 24% (F)	60 cm / 10–14% (M), 16–20% (F)	70+ cm / 6–13% (M), 14–18% (F)